Table 18.1 Launch configuration parameters

Category	ECS	EKS
Portability	ECS is available on AWS. ECS Anywhere is an extension to use ECS for on-premises workloads. Other cloud providers do not support ECS.	EKS is available on AWS. For on-premises workloads, you have EKS Anywhere, which is supported by AWS but requires VMware vSphere and offers the option to deploy and manage Kubernetes yourself. Also, most other cloud providers come with a Kubernetes offering.
License	Proprietary service but free of charge	Open source license (Apache License 2.0)
Ecosystem	Works very well together with many AWS services (e.g., ALB, IAM, and VPC)	Comes with a vibrant open source ecosystem (e.g., Prometheus, Helm). Integration with AWS services exists but is not always mature.
Costs	A cluster is free. Of course, you pay for the compute infrastructure.	AWS charges about $72 per month for each cluster. Also, AWS recommends *not* to deploy workloads that require isolation to the same cluster. On top of that, you are paying for the compute infrastructure.

We observe that Kubernetes is very popular especially, but not only, among developers. Even though we are software developers ourselves, we prefer ECS for most workloads. The most important arguments for us are monthly costs per cluster and integration with other AWS services. On top of that, CloudFormation comes with full support for ECS.

Next, you will learn about the basic concepts behind ECS.